the names, addresses and telephone numbers of the persons or the firms with whom the dealings take place.

2. Each card may be ruled according to the particulars desired to be recorded.

3. Ready information is available for different purposes, e.g., for knowing the number of customers in a particular territory.

4. It has greater flexibility because the number of cards can be increased or decreased as desired. Cards may be grouped and re-grouped in any manner and in any order.

5. The index is always alive since the dead cards are removed and transferred to dead cabinets.

6. Card index can be used by a number of persons at the same time.

### Demerits of Card Index system:

1. There is danger of separate cards being lost by the persons who take them away from the drawers for reference.

2. Ready reference may be difficult if the cards are allowed to be removed freely from the drawers.

3. Card index is blind since cards are not visible at a glance.

4. Card indexing is comparatively costlier than page indexing.

5. Card gets torn or spoiled through constant handling. Thus, they have to be replaced from time to time.

6. Cards may be substituted to commit or to conceal fraud where card ledgers are kept.

Despite these drawbacks, the system of card indexing is very elastic and simple to operate and so is used frequent by libraries, hospitals, banks (for maintaining specimen signature) and other offices (to keep credit records, staff records and so on).

### (c) Visible Index:

The major defect of card indexing is that a large number of cards cannot be seen at one glance. This defect is overcome by visible indexing under which a large number of cards are visible at one glance. Visible card index, strip index and wheel index are the systems of visible indexing.

**1. Visible Card Index:** Visible card index system has gained more popularity in recent years. It is based on the principle "look at the card, not for it". Visible card indexing can be used for retaining records such as accounts receivable, personal history of employees and specimen signatures of customer in a fairly permanent position for frequent reference. The speed in which the cards can be located and the necessary entries made, justifies the use and cost of visible card filing equipment.

The main feature of visible filing is that the main reference (i.e. the main information) on each card is visible at all times. The cards are arranged in such a way that it overlaps the one before it leaving a narrow strip at the bottom containing the name, telephone number of the subject visible.



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